

Dear Editor,

Please consider our manuscript, "Near-Optimal Screening under Fixed Simulation Budgets: Preservation, Efficiency, and the Role of Common Random Numbers," for publication as a research article in *Simulation Modelling Practice and Theory*.

The study examines fixed-budget simulation screening by assessing whole-set near-optimal preservation, screening efficiency, and final recommendation separately. Published double-sided test-to-the-best (DSTTB) is a central comparator, alongside dependence-valid marginal screening, a standardized paired adaptation, and adaptive CPC certification. The comparison connects simulation-study design and variance reduction to the statistical objectives of selection procedures.

Known-mean Gaussian experiments and a dynamic, empirically informed WNBA simulation benchmark show that no architecture dominates all objectives. Under independent Gaussian evidence, published DSTTB retains fewer alternatives than adaptive CPC while preserving the near-optimal set in all observed runs. Under strong common random numbers, explicitly paired evidence can substantially improve screening. Preservation and final recommendation nevertheless require separate assessment. The WNBA application is a simulation benchmark with externally calibrated elasticity and finite-reference evaluation, rather than transaction-level calibration or operational validation. The conditional Gaussian theory is kept distinct from the empirical application and stress results.

Reproducibility materials for the submission are archived at Zenodo: <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.23168599>. The archive contains source code, configurations, deterministic seeds, derived simulation inputs, machine-readable summaries, and table/figure reproduction scripts, with third-party redistribution limitations documented.

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Thank you for considering the manuscript.

Sincerely,

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